



Two cameras to scan!

Samsung is working on a camera system for facial recognition with two under-display cameras. <https://digit.in/oct22-25>



Mandatory Google login

Fitbit will require its users to login using their Google account from next year. <https://digit.in/oct22-26>

To understand the recent shift in the TWS market in a better way, we sat with Mr Gyanendra Singh, Head - Audio Marketing at Sony India Pvt Ltd, for a brief interaction. Here's what he had to say when we asked him about the monumental shift the audio industry has seen, taking it away from the wired earbuds:

"I think two big reasons. One, I think more got to do from a functionality point of view. The usual clutter, one associated with you know, managing device from the time was there. So therefore, there is a need to get away from that across products, not just true wireless. The aspect of going wireless and with the development of the wireless technology that was possible on across. So that's, that's been one of the reasons, which is a more functional aspect of it. And the other is also, I think the usage. The increasing consumption of content has been the other thing. And there is also the aspect of, of a style



Mr Gyanendra Singh,
Head - Audio
Marketing at
Sony India Pvt Ltd

statement, which goes along with the true wireless earbuds. Then there is the form factor, which has caught everyone's fancy.

When it comes to the pandemic impact, it was not that, that TWS wasn't growing before that, but I think that seemed to have accelerated it one-two times. Before that TWS more oriented towards music, and of course, yes, you could take calls, but I think it became a necessity when, when we got into the pandemic. And, this is worldwide, not just one or two markets. So, I think some of these things have really made this shift far more aggressive. In some of the developed countries, as we speak, I think even before the pandemic, the change was already there. And the TWS usage could be as high as 60-65 per cent in some of those markets. In India's case, we've still got, some way to go before we even get to the 50% mark. So I think there is scope but we should note that we are a very diverse country with a large market."

another legion that supported it. Now, after many years when the headphone jack on smartphones is hearing its death bell, and the dust has settled, the AirPods were truly the benchmark that everyone tried to, and so many years later, still tries to achieve. The very simple testament to the success of the AirPods is the fact that the market right now is flooded with similarly named products, and for the layman, AirPods are synonymous with a pair of TWS earbuds.

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Once the AirPods train had caught some

steam and major audio product manufacturers like Sony, Harman, Sennheiser, and the likes also started making their own TWS earbuds for the masses, then the race towards cutting costs and achieving the best value for money ratio started.

There were brands left, right, and centre trying to push the bar even higher in terms of quality at the lowest possible price. It did not take long for earbuds that usually were known to be sold around the ₹7000 mark to be up in the market for almost half the price while also retaining the quality. There was also a shift noticed in features and focus areas. Qualcomm

in their report titled The evolution of true wireless technology very aptly note –

"The first wave of truly wireless devices were designed for voice calls and music streaming; however, use cases have evolved since then demanding that the latest generation of earbuds deliver richer consumer experiences with features including hearing enhancement, Active Noise Cancellation, ambient leak through of sound for situational awareness, and integrated Voice Assistants. A further development challenge for manufacturers is meeting consumer demand for ultra-small form factor earbuds that can be used for many hours at a time while balancing the need for increased processing power to meet the demands of these more sophisticated use cases. Next generation truly wireless headsets in both premium and entry/mid tiers need to support this growing range of features and applications and continue to deliver customer satisfaction with seamless wireless connections."

The onset of the COVID-19 pandemic has also played a role in the expansion of the adoption of TWS earbuds and a significant reduction in their prices. And the effects of the change in the market dynamics have trickled down to the everyday consumers getting better products at reasonable prices. **d**

Growth of truly wireless category

